

Hyalinobatrachium valerioi

La Palma glass frog



Length ¾–1½ in (2–3.5 cm)
Habit Mostly terrestrial
Breeding Rainy season season
Status Least concern



This small, delicate frog has translucent skin that gives it the appearance of being made from glass. It is an excellent climber, with large adhesive disks on its fingers and toes. Females attach their eggs to foliage overhanging streams. When the pink or red tadpoles hatch, they drop into the water and burrow into the mud or sand on the streambed.



Dendrobates auratus

Green and black poison-dart frog



Length 1–2¼ in (2.5–6 cm)
Habit Wholly terrestrial
Breeding Rainy season season
Status Least concern



This brilliantly colored, tropical American frog belongs to a family of about 179 species that includes the most poisonous amphibians in the world. Like its relatives, it lives on the ground, and uses the poison as a defense. Its bright colors show predators that it is toxic, allowing it to



PATERNAL CARE



The female green and black poison-dart frog lays clutches of 5–13 eggs in leaf litter, but it is the male that guards the eggs, sometimes caring for more than one clutch at a time. When the eggs hatch, he carries the tadpoles on his back, to small pools in tree holes.

hop around unmolested on the forest floor. Courtship among green and black poison-dart frogs is conducted in a highly unusual way; females take the lead, enticing the males to mate by beating their partners on the back with their hind feet.

WARNING COLORATION

The green and black poison-dart frog is small with a pointed head. A brightly colored species, it is black with green patches, and may sometimes have a golden sheen. This coloring functions as a warning to predators.

Oophaga pumilio

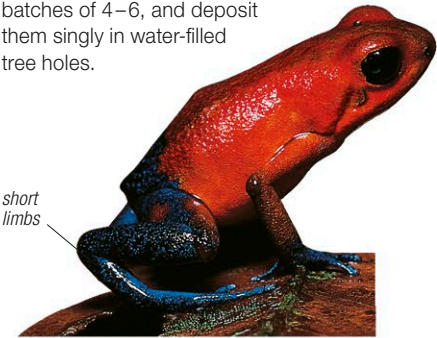
Strawberry poison-dart frog



Length ¾–1 in (2–2.5 cm)
Habit Wholly terrestrial
Breeding Rainy season season
Status Least concern



Although not the most toxic poison dart frog, this Central American species is still highly poisonous. Like other poison dart frogs, it relies on its chemical defense system to keep it out of trouble. Its colors are very variable: in some places it is bright red, but in others it can be brown, blue, or green. Females lay eggs in batches of 4–6, and deposit them singly in water-filled tree holes.



short limbs

Ranitomeya dorisswansonae

Doris Swanson's poison-dart frog



Length ¾–1 in (1.7–1.8 cm)
Habit Wholly terrestrial
Breeding Not known season
Status Vulnerable



Found in the species-rich central cordillera of Colombia in 2006, this tiny frog is strikingly patterned with red

blotches on a black background. It is only known to occur in a forest fragment no bigger than 0.2 square miles (0.5 square km), where it lives on the forest floor and on low-growing bromeliads. It belongs to a genus of small poison-dart frogs recently separated from *Dendrobates* on the basis of genetic evidence. Like all the brightly colored poison dart frogs, the toxins in their skin are derived from insect prey.



Rana temporaria

European common frog



Length 2–4 in (5–10 cm)
Habit Mostly terrestrial
Breeding Spring season
Status Least concern



The common frog is one of the most widespread amphibians in Northern Europe, with a range that extends well

beyond the Arctic Circle. An inhabitant of damp places, it spends most of its adult life on land, returning to water only to escape attack and to breed. In early spring, large numbers of these frogs make their way to shallow ponds. The males call the females with a deep, growl-like croak, and after mating the females lay floating clumps of several thousand eggs. In warm ponds, the tadpoles reach maturity in 6 weeks, but in cool water they can take 4 months.



black bands on hind legs

Hylarana albolabris

Forest white-lipped frog



Length 2¼–4 in (6–10 cm)
Habit Mostly terrestrial
Breeding Summer season
Status Least concern



Frogs belonging to the family Ranidae, often referred to as the “true” frogs, number more than 340 species, and are found in all the world's major continents.

African members are generally poorly known, but those living south of the Sahara belong to the genus *Hylarana*. Characterized by the white stripe on its upper lip, this African species has a pointed snout, prominent folds of skin down each side of its back, and large adhesive disks on its toes. The male has a larger eardrum than the female and, in the breeding season, develops large glands on the upper forelimbs, which enable him to maintain a firm grip on the female while mating. Eggs are laid in still or slow-moving water. This frog lives on low vegetation in secondary rain forest and woodland but is also found in cultivated areas. Its tadpoles have a fringe of skin along their lower lip, the function of which is not known.

Lithobates pipiens

Northern leopard frog

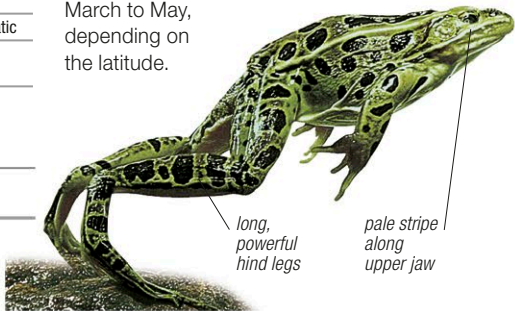


Length 2–3½ in (5–9 cm)
Habit Terrestrial/Aquatic
Breeding Spring season
Status Least concern



This frog is green or brown with a pointed snout, and 2 or 3 rows of large, irregular, dark spots that

have pale borders. Found in meadows near ponds and marshes, it feeds on insects and other invertebrates, and spends winters and dry spells hidden under rocks. The male's call is a loud, deep, rattling “snore,” interspersed with grunts. This frog breeds from March to May, depending on the latitude.



long, powerful hind legs

pale stripe along upper jaw